



why facebook might succeed !



In order to ensure that we do not get too much egg on our collective faces, here's an article that ensures we're safely perched atop the proverbial fence!

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The aim of the stories that you've read on earlier pages was to inform you about some of the problems that Facebook will face after going the IPO way, to ensure that you know how your data is being put to use, and to pass on the important message that you should really broaden your horizons and not ignore other services.

Think of it like something akin to making it a point to use Bing every now and then, especially when Google's not giving you the results you want – you never know, you might actually discover something cool, or get an edge over others by diversifying... and of course, there's also the possibility you might not...

As a more tech-savvy community than the general public, we're pretty sure most of you reading this issue will understand our aim here. Some of you may already think exactly the same way, and some of you will, no doubt, wonder what we've been smoking!

Addiction

The way Facebook's taken off, and the sheer amount of time people spend on it, it's obviously a great online substitute

for real interactions that are few and far between as our lives get busier. Since 800+ million people are already on it, unless some other service starts offering hard cash to close your Facebook account, there's no way the world's getting off it.

We're addicted, and there's no two ways about it. There's just something to be said for being able to find almost everyone you know who's net-savvy, all in one place, all from one account. The sheer convenience of it is unbeatable already, and everyone else is just left playing catch-up, perhaps for good.

Even a mammoth internet company like Google can't really compete with its Google+ network, simply because it's just that far behind. Online socialising, for the foreseeable future (which in internet time, is about 16 months!), will pretty much be dominated by Facebook, and it has to be said, either some other service is going to have to come up with a game-changing feature that w'll want as badly as a junkie needs his fix, or Facebook will have to screw up on a galactic scale for this to change.

It's all about the money

IPOs bring money, money buys more employees, more employees means slicker code, better ideas, and all of that together makes for a better service that will addict us even more.

If anything, Facebook has dominated the social networking scene despite going up against big companies with deep pockets. Google had more cash to splash than anyone, and MySpace had News Corp money behind it (for quite awhile until it was sold to Justin Timberlake and others), and yet it didn't seem to even dent Facebook's progress. So what can we expect when Facebook gets a few billion dollars to play with as they see fit?

What IPOs also bring about is a board of directors that have a very direct say in how the company is run. You can bet some of the smartest financial people on the planet will be looking to ensure their investment in Facebook doesn't fall flat. Perhaps all those minds can come up with even more inven-

tive ways to make money off all of us than was previously thought possible – and do it without making it in your face, or changing your user experience.

